

# OPTIMAL EXPERIENCE

STEPS TOWARD ENHANCING



THE QUALITY OF LIFE

## MIHALY CSIKSZENTMIHALYI

*"Flow couldn't come at a better time for us. An inspiring, worthwhile read."*

*—Chicago Sun-Times*

1980. *Mind play: The creative uses of fantasy*. Engle-  
clentice-Hall.
- ior and conscious experience: A conceptual analysis.  
rsity Press.
- e gulag archipelago. New York: Harper & Row.
- ms in altruistic love and behavior, a symposium. Boston:
- bles in modern sociology. Chicago: Regnery.
- ultural dynamics. New York: Bedminster.
- id power of love. Chicago: Regnery.
- nemory palace of Matteo Ricci. New York: Viking
- ). *Ethics*. Trans. G. Eliot. Wolfeboro, N.H.: Long-  
oup.
- and human nature: Theoretical papers of Melford E.  
ersity of Chicago Press.
- orce. New York: Viking.
- n Heidegger. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- triangle of love: Intimacy, passion, commitment. New
- exploration among the Sinoi. In T. Roszak, ed.,  
larper & Row.
- chwarz, N., eds. 1990. *The social psychology of subjec-*  
ork: Pergamon.
- terpersonal theory of psychiatry. New York: Norton.
- Comparison of Csikszentmihalyi's theory and Chuang-  
presented at the meetings of the Anthropological  
tudy of Play, Montreal, March.
- ct of research on education. Washington, D.C.: Na-  
lucation.
- construction of communities. Chicago: University of
- of time: Daily activities of urban...
- Toscano, M. 1986. Scuola e vita quotidiana: Un caso di selezione culturale. In  
F. Massimini & P. Inghilleri, eds., *L'esperienza quotidiana* (pp. 305-18).  
Milan: Franco Angeli.
- Tough, A. 1978. *Adults' learning prospects: A fresh approach to theory and practice  
in adult learning*. Toronto: Ontario Institute for Studies in Education.
- Toynbee, A. J. 1934. *A study of history*. London: Oxford University Press.
- Treisman, A. M., & Gelade, G. 1980. A feature integration theory of attention.  
*Cognitive Psychology* 12:97-136.
- Treisman, A. M., & Schmidt, H. 1982. Illusory conjunctions in the perception  
of objects. *Cognitive Psychology* 14:107-41.
- Trivers, R. L. 1972. Parental investment and sexual selection. In B. H. Camp-  
bell, ed., *Sexual selection and the descent of man, 1871-1971* (pp. 136-79).  
Chicago: Aldine.
- Tucker, R. C. 1972. *Philosophy and myth in Karl Marx*. 2d ed. Cambridge:  
Cambridge University Press.
- Turnbull, C. M. 1961. *The forest people*. Garden City, N.Y.: Doubleday.
- . 1972. *The mountain people*. New York: Simon & Shuster.
- Turner, V. 1969. *The ritual process*. New York: Aldine.
- . 1974. Liminal to liminoid in play, flow, and ritual: An essay in compar-  
ative symbology. *Rice University Studies* 60(3):53-92.
- USA Today. 1987. An interview with Susumu Tonegawa. Oct. 13, p. 1A.
- U.S. Dept. of Commerce. 1980. *Social indicators, III*. Washington, D.C.: Bureau  
of the Census.
- U.S. Dept. of Commerce. 1985. *Statistical abstracts of the U.S., 1986*. 100th ed.  
Washington, D.C.: Bureau of the Census.
- U.S. Dept. of Health & Human Services. 1988. *Vital statistics of the United  
States, 1985, II*. Hyattsville, Md.: U.S. Dept. of Health.
- U.S. Dept. of Justice. 1987. *Uniform Crime Reports 1987*. Washington, D.C.:  
Dept. of Justice.
- Vaillant, G. E. 1977. *Adaptation to life*. Boston: Little, Brown.
- Vasari, G. 1550 (1959). *Lives of the most eminent painters, sculptors, and architects*.  
New York: Random House.

- against death. Middletown, Conn.: Wesleyan University Press.
- Leistungsentwicklung des Kindes. Jena: G. Fischer.
- The source of civilization in the natural selection of nation in genes and cultures. *Zygon* 11(3):263-303.
- Intelligence and reason as adaptations to nature's requirements. *Journal of Theoretical Biology* 31:1-31.
- Prison confinement. London: Macmillan.
- Les hommes et les femmes. Paris: Gallimard.
- The river that flows uphill: A journey from the big bang to the present. New York: Macmillan.
- Aspiration, satisfaction, and fulfillment. In A. P. Campbell & J. E. Campbell, eds., *The human meaning of social change* (pp. 1-10). New York: Russell Sage.
- Quality of life. In P. E. P. & W. L. Rodgers, eds., *The quality of life* (pp. 1-10). New York: Russell Sage.
- Variation and selective retention in socio-cultural evolution. In G. I. Blankston & R. W. Monk, eds., *Social learning areas* (pp. 19-42). Cambridge: Schenkman.
- Conflicts between biological and social evolution and psychology and moral tradition. *American Psychologist* 30:1103-1110.
- Natural epistemology. In D. A. Schlipp, ed., *The library of Theoria* (pp. 413-63). LaSalle, Ill.: Open Court.
- La psicologia e la qualità dell'esperienza. In F. Massimini & P. Inghilleri, eds., *L'esperienza quotidiana* (pp. 285-304). Milan: Franco Angeli.
- They became what they beheld. New York: Ballantine.
- Qualities. New York: Holt.
- Freedom in meditation. New York: Doubleday Anchor.
- Al Virginians at play. Williamsburg, Va.: Colonial Williamsburg Foundation.
- Through the interior parts of North America. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press.
- Cohler, B. J. 1982. Personal narrative and the life course. In P. B. Bates & O. G. Brim, eds., *Life span development and behavior*, vol. 4. New York: Academic Press.
- Collingwood, R. G. 1938. *The principles of art*. London: Oxford University Press.
- Conrad, P. 1982. *Television: The medium and its manners*. Boston: Routledge & Kegan.
- Cooley, C. H. 1902. *Human nature and the social order*. New York: Charles Scribner's Sons.
- Cooper, D. 1970. *The death of the family*. New York: Pantheon.
- Cousins, N. 1979. *Anatomy of an illness as perceived by the patient*. New York: Norton.
- Crandall, J. E. 1984. Social interest as a moderator of life stress. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 47:164-74.
- Crandall, M. 1983. On walking without touching the ground: "Play" in the *Inner Chapters* of the Chuang-Tzu. In V. H. Muir, ed., *Experimental essays on Chuang-Tzu* (pp. 101-23). Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press.
- Crealock, W. I. B. 1951. *Vagabonding under sail*. New York: David McKay.
- Croce, B. 1902 (1909). *Aesthetics*. New York: Macmillan.
- . 1962. *History as the story of liberty*. London: Allen & Unwin.
- Crook, J. H. 1980. *The evolution of human consciousness*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Csikszentmihalyi, I. 1986. Il flusso di coscienza in un contesto storico: Il caso dei gesuiti. In F. Massimini & P. Inghilleri, eds., *L'esperienza quotidiana* (pp. 181-96). Milan: Franco Angeli.
- . 1988. Flow in a historical context: The case of the Jesuits. In M. Csikszentmihalyi & I. S. Csikszentmihalyi, eds., *Optimal experience: Psychological studies of flow in consciousness* (pp. 232-48). New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Csikszentmihalyi, M. 1965. Artistic problems and their solution: An exploration of creativity in the arts. Unpublished doctoral dissertation, University of Chicago.
- . 1968. A cross-cultural comparison of some structural characteristics of the flow experience. *Journal of Cross-Cultural Psychology* 1:1-10.